



Plants for boundaries, hedges, and windbreaks

Hedging and wall plants are both decorative and useful, helping to create shelter, mark boundaries, and divide up large gardens.

Conifers make excellent hedges, but most prefer a sunny site. Evergreens to consider for shady areas include firethorn, boxwood, and laurel. Oakleaf hydrangea, mountain laurel, and forsythia can provide texture and add colorful blooms to a dark spot in the garden. However, all these plants need sun for part of the day to put on a good show. For areas in dense shade, opt for a holly or Japanese laurel to create your hedge. If you are using large shrubs, clip them to size and shape; smaller shrubs can be used as edging or low hedges.



TREE LARGE

Carpinus betulus

EUROPEAN HORNBEAM This deciduous tree has oval, corrugated dark green leaves that turn yellow and orange in fall. Green catkins in spring precede clusters of winged nuts. A formal or informal hedging plant, trim it in late summer and midwinter.

↑80ft (25m) ↔70ft (20m)

☀ Z4–8



SHRUB LARGE

Elaeagnus x ebbingei

OLEASTER This vigorous evergreen shrub has oval dark green leaves that are dusted with gray flecks. It produces small, scented white flowers in fall. Plant it as a screen or windbreak. It tolerates light shade only; trim in late summer.

↑↑15ft (5m)

☀ Z7–9



SHRUB MEDIUM

Hydrangea quercifolia

SNOW QUEEN

OAKLEAF HYDRANGEA A deciduous shrub with large, lobed green leaves that turn purple and red in fall. Its white conical late summer flower heads form, turning pink as they age. Use as a screen; clip it in spring.

↑6ft (2m) ↔8ft (2.5m)

☀ Z5–9 (N)



TREE LARGE

Ilex aquifolium

ENGLISH HOLLY An evergreen shrub or tree with wavy-edged, spiny dark green leaves and scarlet berries on pollinated female plants. Thornless and variegated forms are also available. Trim with pruners in late summer. Considered invasive.

↑up to 70ft (20m) ↔20ft (6m)

☀ (N) Z7–9



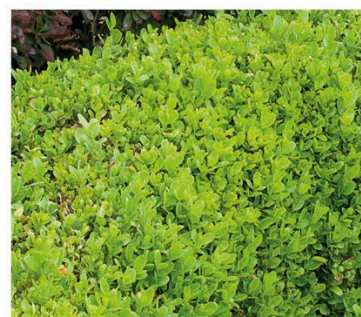
SHRUB MEDIUM

Aucuba japonica

JAPANESE LAUREL A rounded evergreen shrub with oval, glossy green leaves. Small purple spring flowers are followed by red berries on female plants, if a male plant is grown close by. Many varieties with yellow spotted leaves are available.

↑↑6ft (2m)

☀ (N) Z7–10



SHRUB LARGE

Buxus sempervirens

COMMON BOXWOOD An evergreen shrub with small, oval, glossy green foliage and tiny yellowish spring flowers. A classic hedging and topiary plant, clip in late spring or early summer to allow time for the new growth to mature to avoid frost damage.

↑↑15ft (5m)

☀ Z6–8



SHRUB LARGE

Fatsia japonica

JAPANESE FATZIA An evergreen shrub with large, palm-shaped, glossy dark green leaves. Round white flower heads in fall are followed by black fruits. Use as an informal screen; prune in spring, if required. Can be grown as a houseplant in cooler areas.

↑↑12ft (4m)

☀ Z8–10



SHRUB LARGE

Forsythia x intermedia

BORDER FORSYTHIA A vigorous deciduous shrub with long stems of golden-yellow early spring flowers before the small green foliage appears. Grow as an informal hedge; prune after flowering. 'Lynwood Variety' (above) has larger golden blooms.

↑↑10ft (3m)

☀ Z5–8



SHRUB LARGE

Kalmia latifolia

MOUNTAIN LAUREL A dense evergreen shrub with glossy dark green foliage. In early summer, large clusters of pale pink flowers open from darker pink, attractively crimped buds. Grow it as a flowering screen, and prune lightly after flowering.

↑↑10ft (3m)

☀ pH (N) Z4–9